



THE EGYPTIAN • WESTERN DESERT

04

Western Desert Mystical

Rohlfs' cave, the Roman wells and three nights on the sand

A journey you can picture yourself inside

In 1873 Gerhard Rohlfs found the Djara Cave — stalactites, stalagmites and faint rock art left by people who sheltered there. This journey reaches it on the second day, then works west through the Roman wells and the English Track to the White Desert, and finishes with a lodge night and a hot shower.

The fourth of nine, and the shortest tour that includes the Djara Cave with nights in the desert rather than a return to the lodge.

THE NINE, BY LENGTH IN DAYS

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
3	4	4	5	7	12	12	15	20

SHORTEST

EACH IS BOOKED ON ITS OWN

DEEPEST

HOW YOU TRAVEL

Vehicle · Camping and Eco-Lodge. Cairo return · 5 days · Any group size. Each of the nine journeys is a separate booking with its own start and finish; none is a stage of another.

IMPORTANT

This is the intended route, not a fixed timetable.

It communicates the ground covered, the pace and the level of effort. Named properties, exact camp locations, departure times, prices and meal inclusions are confirmed at booking. Weather, park authorities, soft sand and vehicle recovery can change the order or content of a day; this guide names those dependencies wherever they affect your choice.

Every day carries the same four facts

ROUTE

Where the day starts, what it passes through and where it ends.

SLEEP

Tent or bed, and where. Camps are chosen on the day; the area is fixed, the exact spot is not.

DISTANCE

Kilometres where the source gives them, on foot for the walking tours, otherwise an estimate.

MEALS

What is included that day. Anything not listed is not included.

RHYTHM

A reading of how much the day asks of you, followed by the kind of ground it crosses.

■ Easy

Road transfer, an oasis day, or a short walk. Recoverable.

■ Steady

A full day of driving or walking, with stops. The normal shape.

■ Demanding

Long hours, soft sand, recovery work or a hard walk. Plan around it.

FREE TIME

Noted where a day holds unstructured hours. Desert days rarely do; the group moves together and the camp is made together.

Western Desert Mystical

NIGHTS CAMPING	3
NIGHTS IN LODGES	1 · Bahariya, night 4
ROUND TRIP	700+ km road · 800+ km in Landcruisers
GROUND COVERED	Black Desert · Rajeh · Agabat · Djara Cave · Ein El Serw · Karaween · El Wadi · White Desert · Crystal Mountain

HOW THE DAYS GROUP	
Black Desert and Agabat	Day 1
The cave and the dunes	Day 2
The English Track	Day 3
White Desert to the oasis	Day 4
The oasis and home	Day 5

01

Cairo — Bahariya — Agabat

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Cairo → Bahariya Oasis → Black Desert → Rajeh Dunes → Agabat Labyrinth	Camp · Agabat	≈370 km road, short off-road	Lunch, dinner

■ EASY · ROAD AND DUNE

Assemble in Cairo, drive to Bahariya and take lunch in the oasis. Then out into the desert: the Black Desert, sandboarding down the Rajeh dunes, and camp for the night among the chalk formations of the Agabat labyrinth.

02

Agabat — Djara Cave — Karaween Dunes

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Agabat → Djara Cave → Ein El Serw → Karaween Dunes	Camp · Karaween Dunes	≈100 km off-road	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · CAVE AND DUNE

Break camp and drive to the Djara Cave, where lunch is taken. The faint rock art is easy to walk past; it is pointed out. A brief stop at the Roman well of Ein El Serw, then on to the Karaween dunes for the second camp.

03 Karaween — English Track — White Desert

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Karaween Dunes → El Wadi → English Track → White Desert National Park	Camp · White Desert National Park	≈70 km off-road	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · OFF-ROAD

Leave the Karaween dunes behind and drop into El Wadi, the valley, before picking up the old English track. The day ends inside the White Desert National Park with camp set among the formations.

04 White Desert — Crystal Mountain — Bahariya

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
White Desert → El Santa → Ein Khadra → Crystal Mountain → Bahariya Oasis	Eco-Lodge · Bahariya	≈120 km	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · OFF-ROAD TO OASIS

The last sunrise in the White Desert is worth the walk — soft light on white chalk. Then El Santa, the Roman acacia, Ein Khadra, and Crystal Mountain, before checking into the eco-lodge in Bahariya for a hot shower and a bed.

05 Bahariya – Cairo

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Bahariya inner-oasis tour → English Mountain → palm and olive groves → Cairo	—	≈370 km	Breakfast, lunch

EASY · OASIS AND RETURN

A short tour inside the oasis: the English Mountain, the old palm groves and the olive gardens. An optional run through town for olive oil, olives, dates and camel-wool blankets, then lunch and the drive back.

NOTE	Estimated arrival in Cairo 5–6pm.
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What the price carries, and what it does not

INCLUDED

- Assembly pickup and drop-off at an agreed Cairo location — 700+ km round trip
- Lodge accommodation for 1 night (night 4)
- Transport in reliable Toyota Landcruisers — 800+ km
- All meals listed in the itinerary
- Drinks, snacks and fruit — water, tea, coffee, mint
- Desert gear: kitchen, camping and recovery equipment
- Tents, sleeping mats, sleeping bags and blankets
- A friendly, English-speaking, experienced guide and a cook for the journey

NOT INCLUDED

- White Desert National Park tickets
- Personal expenses
- Travel and medical insurance
- Alcoholic beverages
- Tips and gratuities

RATES

Priced on enquiry.

The source itinerary publishes no rate card. Every one of these journeys is quoted against the group — its size, its dates and any tailoring — so the figure is set on enquiry. This panel is reserved for the rate line and the deposit terms once you supply them.

Where this journey asks more of you

Three consecutive nights in tents before the lodge night on night four.

Transfers from Cairo are by hired sedan; the desert is travelled in Landcruisers.

The Djara Cave is entered on foot and the floor is uneven. It is the centrepiece of the tour, not an optional stop.

Active November to April. Any group size can be arranged.

SEASON

Active November to April. Outside that window the heat makes the deep desert unworkable.

PHYSICAL DEMAND

Minimum endurance to walk the sites, the temples and the desert hikes, and to sit long hours in a vehicle over rough ground.

GROUP

Any group size. Departures are private to the group.

VEHICLES AND GEAR

Toyota Landcruisers, stocked with supplies, kitchen, camping and recovery gear. Tents, mats, sleeping bags and blankets are provided.

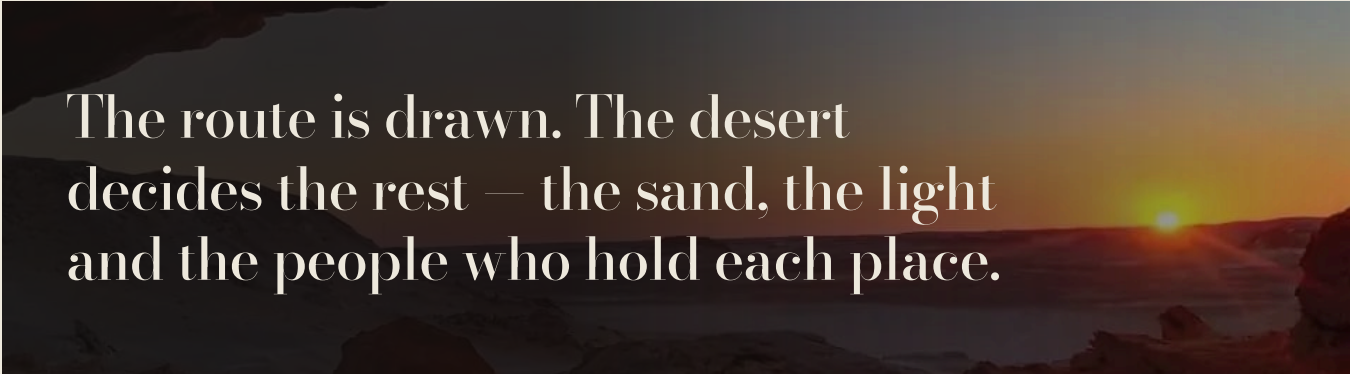
TAILORING

This journey can be tailored for a specific number of travellers, and the day order can be adjusted around your dates. Contact us for an offer.

From this guide to a confirmed departure

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| 01 | Tell us the shape of the group | Numbers, dates in the November-to-April window, and anything the itinerary should bend around — age, mobility, diet, or a date that matters. |
| 02 | Receive the offer | A quoted price against that group, with the lodges named, the vehicles counted and the inclusions fixed against this itinerary. |
| 03 | Confirm and prepare | A kit list, park ticket costs, insurance requirements and the final day plan follow confirmation. |
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ENQUIRIES	This journey can be tailored for a specific number of travellers. Contact us for an offer against your own dates.
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The route is drawn. The desert
decides the rest — the sand, the light
and the people who hold each place.